Sponsored by AYSO Region 154, Cypress, California

2026 Cypress Kamhi Cup Tournament Rules

CATEGORY	RULE
1) JURISDICTION	A. Unless otherwise noted, the current AYSO National Rules and Regulations, Section 11, and FIFA Laws of the Game will be used for this tournament. The following rules are intended specifically for this tournament ONLY! B. The Tournament Committee (incl. Tournament Director, Assistant Director(s), Field Director, Referee Director, and other designated staff) will have jurisdiction over all games played. Disputes will be resolved by the end of the soccer day. C. Referee judgment calls are NOT subject to dispute or protest!
2) FEES	A. Teams may pay by credit card during online registration. Fees are $650
3) ACCEPTANCE	A. Applications are due no later than **November 30th, 2026.** B. Applications will be accepted on a first-come basis, based on completed application (see Team Application Form for criteria). Teams will be notified by email within 48 hours of receipt of their applications. C. Teams not accepted into the tournament will be offered the opportunity to be placed on a waiting list. If a team chooses not to be on a waiting list, the entry fee will be returned within 48 hours of notification. D. The primary form of communication between the Tournament and applying teams will be email and the Tournament website. Teams must designate a Team Contact on their application who has email and Internet access.
4) REFUNDS	A. Teams withdrawing on or before **November 15th, 2026**, will be issued a full refund. B. Teams withdrawing after **November 15th, 2026**, will only be issued a refund if a replacement team can be found. C. If the tournament is canceled and cannot be rescheduled, a full refund will be issued.
5) RAINOUT/ CANCELLATION	A. Tournament plays rain or shine if conditions are safe and permitting. B. If the tournament cannot be held due to conditions beyond the control of the tournament hosts and is canceled prior to the start of the first games, a full refund will be sent to all teams. C. Rainout dates are December 19-20, 2026. If the tournament is canceled due to conditions beyond the control of the tournament hosts after partially completing games but before completing the guaranteed 3 games, a refund will be issued to teams on a prorated basis, based on the actual number of games played. D. If the tournament is canceled after teams have completed their guaranteed 3 games, NO refunds will be given. A. If the tournament is canceled after guaranteed 3 games prior to the start of or during the medal rounds, NO refunds will be given. *See Medal Rounds for additional information.
6) PLAYERS/TEAMS	A. Players on participating teams must be properly registered to play in AYSO. Coaches are responsible for ensuring that all players meet eligibility requirements. B. The team roster must be verified and approved by each player's Regional Commissioner. Roster changes may be submitted (with the written approval of the Regional Commissioner); however, if these changes occur after **December 5, 2026**, then it is the responsibility of the coach to bring the new roster to check in with him/her. C. 3 Guest Players will be allowed for each team. However, the Guest Player will be required to have the approval of both the Guest Player's Regional Commissioner and the Host Team Regional Commissioner (see Guest Player Form). Each guest player must be listed on the roster. D. **Roster Limits:** a. Division U-14 will play 11-v-11, and there will be a roster limit of 15 players per team. b. Division U-12 will play 9-v-9, and there will be a roster limit of 12 players per team. c. Division U-10 will play 7-v-7, and there will be a roster limit of 10 players per team. E. All players must play at least half of each game. Violation of these player rules exposes a team to protest and renders them subject to forfeiture of the game and possible disqualification at the discretion of the Tournament Director. F. Players may play up a division, but they may not play down a division. G. There is no play time restriction for the Goalkeeper.
7) COACHES	A. Each team is limited to two coaches but must have two – one Head Coach and one Assistant Coach. These

	coaches must be the ones listed on the Official Blue Sombrero Team Roster. B. Each Coach must provide their AYSO Identification Number, be a currently registered volunteer, Safe-Haven certified, and AYSO trained at the appropriate age level. C. Coaches are expected to set an example for their team in exhibiting proper AYSO behavior and Kids Zone behavior. Coaches are expected to remain in the technical area during games and only enter the field of play as requested by the referee. D. Coaches are to be prepared with a set of pinnies for their team in case they're playing another team of the same jersey color. The tournament isn't responsible for providing pinnies. E. Coaches are expected to be prepared with a first aid kit & Ice Packs. F. The Head Coach may only coach one team per division.
8) REFEREES	**A. THE TOURNAMENT WILL PROVIDE ALL REFEREES FOR THIS TOURNAMENT.**
9) FIELDS	A. All fields will be set up and taken down by the tournament staff & Region 154 teams. B. Trash receptacles will be provided at each field. Teams will be expected to clean up all trash in their area before leaving. C. Please observe the following Facility Use Rules while attending the tournament. **a. No pets or animals are allowed at any of the fields. If you are found to have a pet on the field, you will be asked to leave the premises immediately or your team is subject to forfeiture of its current or next game.** b. Smoking is prohibited at every field.
10) FORMAT	A. This is a pool-play tournament. B. Each age division will be bracketed into playing pools. Each team will play a minimum of 3 preliminary play games within their respective pools. C. Teams will advance from qualifying pools based on pool play standings points. The number of teams advancing per pool will be determined by the number of pools in the division. D. Group Play results and standings are not official until validated by tournament officials after the conclusion of Group Play on Sunday.
11) CHECK-IN	A. Teams must check in 1 hour prior to their first game, on Saturday, December 12, 2026. B. Each coach or team representative must provide: a. Roster signed by your RC (if not already provided) b. Medical Release Forms c. 4-6 Filled out game cards with your entire roster for the tournament (I know you're all contenders, so plan on game cards through the Finals of your bracket) C. Coaches must have the Roster signed by RC and Medical Release Forms with them at all times and ready for presentation to Tournament Officials. D. Check-in location will be emailed to all teams within (1) week of the tournament commencing.
12) FIELD MONITORS	A. Tournament Staff will be the first to respond to any incidents or injuries. Tournament participants are encouraged to report any concerns immediately to the Tournament Staff and to respectfully follow any instructions provided by the Tournament Staff.
13) GAMES	A. Pool play games will consist of 20 to 30-minute halves, depending on the age division (see chart below), with a maximum five-minute half-time. There will be a running clock during the match, including substitutions. Games are expected to end on time and may be shortened if they start late. Pool play games may end in a tie. B. Championship games will be full-length for that division (see chart below). Championship, consolation, semi, & quarter final games will be played until there is a winner (see Medal Round rules below). C. Game duration shall be as follows: **Division — Pool, Qtr & Semi — Final Rounds** U- 10: 20-minute half 25-minute half U- 12 25-minute half 30-minute half U-14: 30-minute half 35-minute half D. Medal Round Matches are all Quarter Finals, Semi Finals, Consolation, & Final Matches

	E. The "home" team will be the first team or top team listed on the game schedule and will be responsible for providing the game ball. The home team will be situated on the North or East side of the field, and the visitor will be situated on the South or West side. Spectators must remain on the side of the field designated for their team. The home team will change jerseys or switch to pinnies in the event of a color conflict with the visiting team. If any questions arise, the referee will determine whether this is necessary. F. There will be no warming up on the field. Teams must warm up prior to taking the field. As soon as the previous game has ended, teams must clear the field, and the teams for the next game must take their places. G. FORFEITS: There will be a ten-minute grace period at the start of the game for a team to take the field before a forfeit is declared. The score for a forfeit match will be 1-0 for the remaining team (See STANDINGS for the points to be awarded). *The tournament director, at his discretion, may make a separate determination if a forfeit gives a team an unfair advantage.* For U-10 division teams, there must be a minimum of 5 players on the field for a game to continue. For U-12, the minimum number of players is 6. For all other divisions, there must be at least 7 players to continue the game. If a team cannot field the minimum number of players, the game will be abandoned, and a forfeit will be declared. H. SUSPENDED GAMES: The Tournament Committee may determine to end matches early if the field schedule is behind due to game delays, interference, or if weather conditions provide unsafe conditions; and may distribute awards according to games played and points. The Tournament Committee will determine the outcome of any single game that is terminated prematurely (due to inclement weather, participant injury, or interference by an outside party, etc.). I. ABANDONED GAMES: If any pool play games cannot be played due to circumstances beyond the control of the tournament, the final standings of the pool will be determined by applying the Winning Percentage formula (Total Points Earned in all Games Played divided by Total Points Possible for the Number of Games Played) to each team in the pool. Note. This does not apply to games that were shortened due to a late start. Only the Tournament Director or designee may declare a game abandoned or not played.
14) SUBSTITUTIONS	A. Substitutions shall be allowed approximately midway through each half, at half-time, and in the event of an injury for divisions U-10 through U-14 and will be recorded on the game cards by the referee. B. All substitutions must be approved and recognized by the referee. Substitutions may be made for injured players; however, they may not return until the beginning of the next quarter and will be considered as having played the current quarter (exception: an injured player not replaced may return to play at any time with the referee's permission).
15) STANDINGS	A. Standings for pool play games will be determined on the "ten-point system" as follows: WIN = 6 points TIE = 3 points LOSS = 0 points GOAL = 1 point per goal up to a maximum of 3 per game SHUTOUT = 1 point for a shutout, including a 0-0 tie FORFEIT = 8 points (scored as a 1-0 win) RED CARD/ EJECTION = 2 point deduction for team (for each player, substitute, coach, or spectator) YELLOW CARD = 1 point deduction for 3 yellow cards earned in a single match B. Winners of ties in standings will be determined as follows: Head-to-head competition Goals allowed – up to a maximum of three (3) per game. The fewest goals allowed advance. Goals For – up to a maximum of three (3) per game. Highest number advances Shots from the mark will be the last tie breaker. C. Wildcard teams will be the team(s) with the highest standings points from all teams in the division who are not automatically advancing. D. Standings will be updated hourly on the tournament website. The deadline to challenge the posted results will be at the conclusion of Pool Play.
16) ADVANCEMENTS	A. Pool winners (and in some cases, wildcard teams) will advance to medal round play. B. Teams will play semi-final and/or championship final matches, depending on the number of teams in each pool and the format of play for that flight.
17) MEDAL-ROUNDS	A. All medal round matches (Quarter, Semi, Consolation, & Final) ending in a tie will go directly to FIFA Kicks from the Mark. There will be no overtime. The correct sized goal will be used according to the division taking the kicks.

	B. If medal rounds are canceled*, then medal round winners will be determined by current standings that include semi-finals. Medals will be mailed out to the address given on the application. C. *This is a very rare occurrence and only happens if there is a safety issue, city/school cancellation, or hazard on the fields.
18) AWARDS	A. Medals will be presented to coaches and players from the first place through fourth place teams in U-10 through U14 Divisions (note, there will be no 3rd/4th place medals awarded if the division is only 4 teams). B. Team Mementos will be distributed on Saturday when the team first checks in. Teams are to pick up mementos on Saturday or Sunday.
19) CONDUCT	A. Coaches will be expected to set a positive example for the team and will be held responsible for the actions of their team, including spectators. All spectators must remain behind the control line and between the 18-yard lines (penalty areas in small fields). Two coaches maximum per team, and they must remain in the marked coaching area (within 10 yards of either side of the halfway line). B. Referees will be required to complete a game misconduct report for all misconducts during the game, as well as any incidents of interference by spectators. C. Any coach or spectator ejected must immediately leave the vicinity of the playing field (out of sight and sound) and will be prohibited from attending the next scheduled game. Any player sent off (red carded) must immediately leave the vicinity of the game (under supervision of his/her parent or Safe Haven-certified adult) and may not return to the field of play during the current game, including for the post-game handshake, and may not be substituted for. In the alternative, the player may remain on the sideline under the coach's supervision. There will be penalty point deductions for all send-offs (see Standings rules). Suspension of a player or coach for the following game will be determined by the Tournament Director, depending on the circumstances of the ejection. D. If it is determined that an ineligible player has participated in a game, the team will forfeit all games in which that player participated illegally. Furthermore, if it is determined that the coach knowingly played an ineligible player, that coach will be barred from further participation in the tournament. E. It is mandatory to play a scheduled game. If it is determined that a coach willfully fails to have his team participate in a scheduled game, the coach will be dismissed from the tournament, and the incident will be reported to the respective Regional Commissioner. F. All conduct problems will be reported to the respective Regional Commissioner. G. All Serious Incidents will be reported to the respective Regional Commissioner as well as Area, Section, and AYSO National Office.
20) MEDICAL/FIRST AID	A. There will be a First Aid station at the main tent where participants may receive ice, etc., for minor injuries. B. If an injury is serious, the Tournament Staff will call 911 for emergency response. C. Directions to the nearest hospital/urgent care center will be available at the First Aid station.
21) UNIFORMS/SAFETY	A. All players must wear the approved AYSO uniform only according to the National Rules & Regulations, and all players on the same team must wear matching uniforms (goalkeeper excepted – may have a different jersey). B. Each player's uniform must be marked with a permanently affixed unique number that matches the uniform number on the Game Card and may not exchange numbered jerseys with any other player during the game, including the goalkeeper. C. Garments may be worn under the uniform (i.e., long sleeves, etc.) during inclement weather; the match referee will be the judge of what should be allowed or not. D. Not allowed: jewelry, hard metal, or plastic clips on clothing or hair. No player will be allowed to participate with any type of cast or splint. Removal of any type of cast or splint at the field or surrounding area to participate shall disqualify that team member from participation. E. AYSO will not prohibit the use of knee braces by players in AYSO events and programs, provided that the brace is adequately covered and padded in the judgment of the referee, so as to eliminate the possibility of causing injury to the other players on the field.
22) PROTESTS	A. Protests will be considered only for the following reasons: • An ineligible player has played. • One or more registered player(s), present and in uniform, have not played the required one half of the game (except for illness or injury as recorded by the game referee). B. All protests must be presented in writing to the Tournament Director within 30 minutes of the completion of the game. C. All protests will be heard by a Protest Committee of at least three people selected by the Tournament Director. In all cases, the members of the Protest Committee will be unrelated to either team involved in the protest. ALL PROTEST DECISIONS ARE FINAL!

	D. Referee judgment calls are FINAL and are not grounds for nor subject to protest or dispute!
23) RULES INTERPRETATION	**The Tournament Director retains the right to interpret and apply the tournament rules to the optimum benefit of all tournament participants.**